

Ternstroemia luquillensis

palo colorado

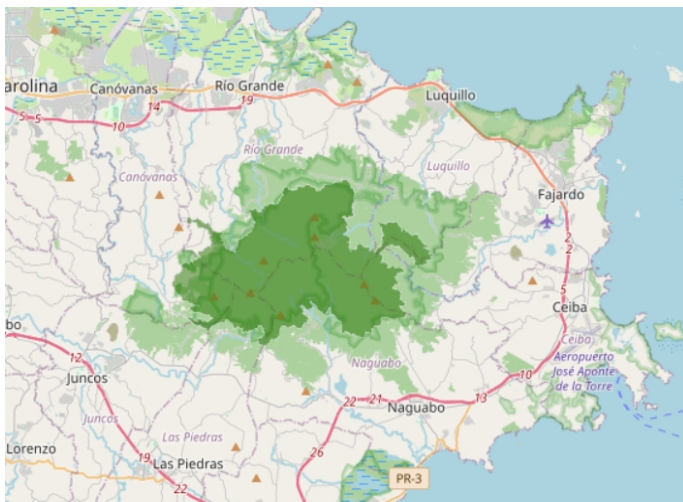
Family (Pentaphylacaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

It is an evergreen tree that can reach up to 20 meters in height, with smooth dark gray bark. It has coriaceous, elliptic-shaped leaves and solitary, fragrant, creamy-white flowers. Its fruit is a capsule that contains several small, bright red seeds.



Location/Habitat

The species is located in the Luquillo Mountains within the Caribbean National Forest, a volcanic region with rugged topography. It inhabits acidic soils of varying depth and drainage on steep terrain and is primarily associated with palo colorado forest and dwarf (elfin) forest.